alliances, confederations, international organizations, even industrial organizations, cultural organizations, religious organizations—must be dealt with in the study of international relations, if the treatment is to be realistic".

A more convincing definition has been provided by Frankel[7]: "This new discipline is more than a combination of the studies of the foreign affairs of the various countries and of international history—it includes also the study of international society as a whole and of its institutions and processes. It is increasingly concerned not only with the states and their interactions but also with the web of trans-national politics".

Mathiesen[8] gives a much broader definition of international relations and suggests that "International Relations embraces all kinds of relations traversing state boundaries, no matter whether they are of an economic, legal, political, or any other character, whether they be private or official", and "all human behaviour originating on one side of state boundary and affecting human behaviour on the other side of the boundary".

Goldstein[9] opines that the field of IR primarily "concerns the relationship among the world's governments". But defining IR in such a way, he argues, may seem simplistic, and therefore, to understand IR holistically, the relationship among states is to be understood in relation to the activities of other actors (international organizations, MNCs, individuals), in connection with other social structures (including economic, cultural and domestic politics), and considering historical and geographical influences.

Jackson and Sorenson[10] observe that "the main reason why we should study IR is the fact that the entire populations of the world are divided into separate territorial communities, or independent states, which profoundly affect the way people live". This definition points to the centrality of states and state system in the study of IR but there are other issues as well in contemporary IR. Jackson and Sorenson thus reflect that "at one extreme the scholarly focus is exclusively on states and inter-state relations; but at another extreme IR includes almost everything that has to do with human relations across the world. Therefore, IR seeks to understand how people are provided or